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Roland RF-640

5 reasons why no to buy

5 reasons why not to buy...

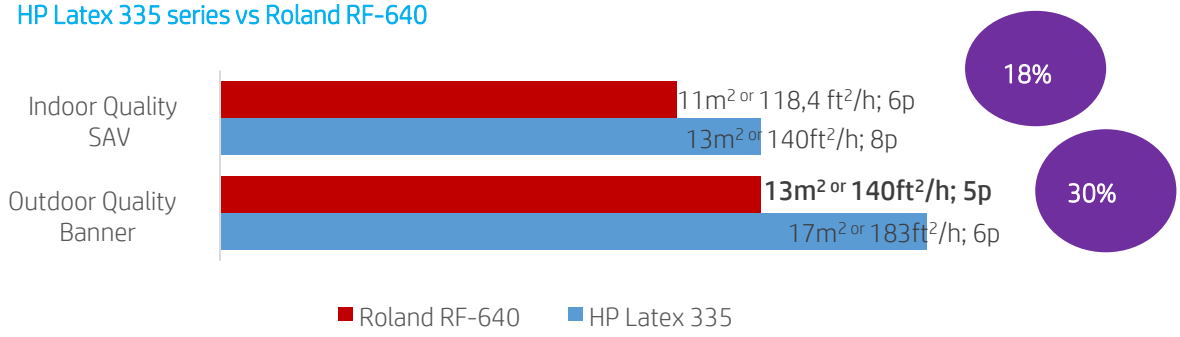
Roland RF-640

1. Dedicated printer for productivity, can't achieve high quality even in slow printmodes

Roland RF-640 is a printer aimed to print at high speed at an acceptable quality, but it will never achieve a high quality.

On top of that, HP latex 335 can print at good quality and is still faster!

HP Latex 335 series vs Roland RF-640



2. Longer turnaround time: no instant dry

Roland Eco-Sol MAX 2 inks have poor scratch resistance. Lamination is required to prevent accidental damages. In order to laminate with solvent technologies, 24 hours media degass is required. In order to increase productivity, manufacturer recommends the installation of the optional heater and blower, which will allow using the take up reel avoiding the print to stick.

3. Quality not consistent over time due to printhead degradation

Piezoelectric printheads tend to have a 1 to 3 year lifespan, but they require intense manual maintenance to achieve this long life. Even with this time-consuming maintenance, printheads will deteriorate as time goes by continuously dropping the quality of prints.

4. Cannot print on uncoated materials

Application versatility on Roland is not as good as on HP Latex printers, Roland cannot print on uncoated materials; quality of the print is not deliverable.

5. Hazardous inks that require special ventilation

Roland RF-640 uses an eco-solvent ink (Eco-Sol MAX 2) as printing technology. Eco stands for economic not for ecologic. The **ink carries a hazardous solvent** which help the pigment penetrate the media and then it evaporates, emitting dangerous gases as stated by Roland itself.

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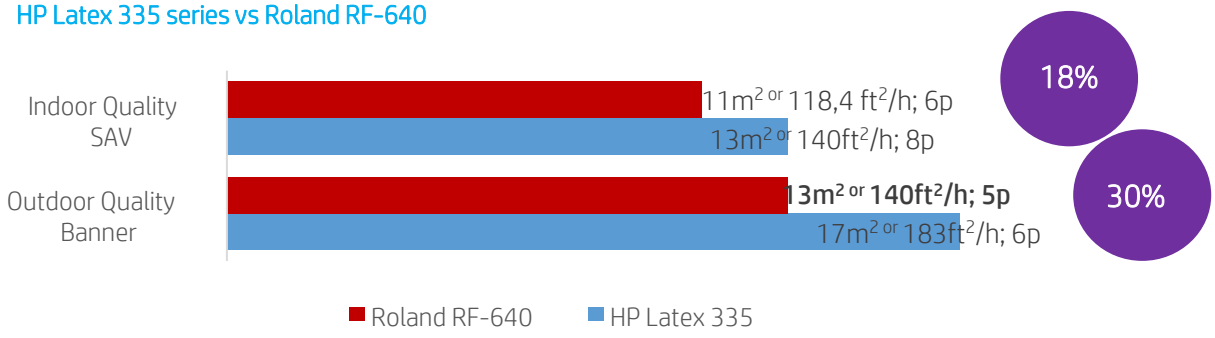
1. Dedicated printer for productivity, can't achieve high quality even in slow printmodes

Roland RF-640 is a printer aimed to print at high speed at an acceptable quality, but it will never achieve a high quality even when the printmode selected is really slow.

When a job with a high quality is required Roland RF-640 is slow and will not be able to deliver the required quality.

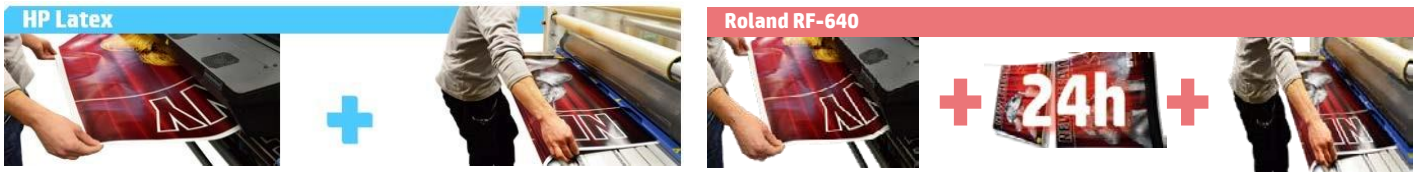
On top of that, HP latex 335 is still more productive than Roland RF for comparable quality for outdoor applications, around 30% and being able to produce high quality prints when requested.

HP Latex 335 series vs Roland RF-640



2. Longer turnaround time: no instant dry

On HP Latex durable prints come out completely dry and scratch resistant, ready to finish and deliver.



For Roland eco-solvent printers lamination is required, as it has a poor scratch resistance. This will lead to the need to degas the samples before laminating, if not, formation of gas bubbles can appear causing a quality problem to end users.

The additional finishing time is a problem with the short turnaround of the industry. The customer might lose the job with Roland.

3. Quality not consistent over time due to printhead degradation

Piezo electric printheads are expensive, but they tend to have a long lifespan. This means that user needs printheads to be reliable and that printheads continue printing with the same quality after 1 or 2 years. In order to achieve this reliability, time consuming maintenance has to be performed weekly.

Even with this time consuming maintenance, **printheads will continue to deteriorate** as time goes by, and the drops won't be fired in the same way print after print deriving in print quality issues.

On the other hand, HP latex printheads are cheaper and have to be changed more frequently, but they do not require any kind of maintenance and print **quality will always be the same as the first print**.

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4. Cannot print on uncoated materials

UNCOATED PAPER

Roland RF-640 HP Latex 335

UNCOATED TEXTILES

Roland RF-640 HP Latex 335

UNCOATED WALL COVERINGS

Roland RF-640 HP Latex 335

Application versatility on Roland is not as good as on HP Latex printers, Roland cannot print with the same quality on uncoated materials. The print is not deliverable.

On the other hand, HP Latex printers are able to print on uncoated materials performing very well and being able to delivery prints with quality.

5. Hazardous inks that require special ventilation

Roland RF-640 uses an eco-solvent ink (Eco-Sol MAX 2) as printing technology. Eco stands for economic not for ecologic. The **ink carries a hazardous solvent** which help the pigment penetrate the media and then it evaporates, emitting dangerous gases as stated by Roland itself. The single largest components (~80% by weight) are Diethylene Glycol Ethers, solvents that have been **classified as HAPs** by the US Environmental Protection Agency.

HAPs are those pollutants that cause or may cause cancer or other serious health effects, such as reproductive effects or birth defects, or adverse environmental and ecological effects.

HP Latex inks have water as its main component and enable a healthier approach to signage printingwith advantages from the work zone to the point-of-display of finished prints. HP Latex inks have an extensive range of third party certifications and continues to have the best environmental profile of any solution in the marketplace, no special ventilation required, have low odor and low VOC, no HAPs, nickel free.

HP water-based technology

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Technical specifications Comparison

		HP Latex 335	Roland RF-640
Estimated Street price		Contact your country sales representative for prices	$12.000/€10.900
Technology	HP Thermal Inkjet HP Wide Scan Printing Technology		Piezo inkjet technology
Printing	Printing modes	5 m²/hr (54 ft²/hr) – High Saturation Textiles (20pass)	4 m²/hr (47 ft²/hr) – 1440x720 (8-pass) Vinyl
		6.4 m²/hr (69 ft²/hr) - Backlits, Textiles, and Canvas (16-pass)	6 m²/hr (63 ft²/hr) – 1440x720 (6-pass) Banner
		10.2 m²/hr (110 ft²/hr) - Indoor High Quality (10pass)	11 m²/hr (117 ft²/hr) – 720x720 (6-pass) Vinyl
		12.7 m²/hr (137 ft²/hr) – Indoor Quality (8-pass)	13 m²/hr (141 ft²/hr) – 720x720 (5-pass) Banner
		16.9 m²/hr (182 ft²/hr) – Outdoor Plus (6-pass)	13 m²/hr (141 ft²/hr) – 540x720 (5-pass) Vinyl
		16.9 m²/hr (182 ft²/hr) – Outdoor Economy (6p4c80%)	18 m²/hr (194 ft²/hr) – 360x720 (3-pass) Banner
		23.3 m²/hr (251 ft²/hr) – Outdoor High Speed (4p4c80%))	19 m²/hr (199 ft²/hr) – 360x720 (3-pass) Vinyl
		49.9 m²/hr (537 ft²/hr) – Billboard (2p4c50%)	37 m²/hr (289 ft²/hr) – 360x720 (2-pass) Banner
			49 m²/hr (521 ft²/hr) – 360x360 (1-pass) Banner
	Print resolution	1200 x 1200 dpi	1440 dpi
	Base color configuration	HP Latex Inks Black, cyan, light cyan, light magenta, magenta, yellow, HP Latex Optimizer	Roland ECO-SOL MAX 2 ink. CMYK
	Cartridge size	775 ml	440 ml
Media	Handling	Roll feed; take-up reel	Roll feed, sheet feed, and take-up reel,
	Roll size	254 to 1625-mm (10 to 64-in) rolls (580 to 1625-mm (23 to 64-in) rolls with full support)	25.9 to 162-cm (10.2 to 64-in) rolls,
	Roll weight	42 kg (92.6 lb)	Up to 50 kg (110 lb)
	Roll diameter	250 mm (9.8 in)	Up to 21-cm (8.3-in) outside diameter
	Thickness	Up to 0.5 mm (19.7 mil)	Up to 1.0 mm (39 mil) with liner
Connectivity	Interfaces (standard)	Gigabit Ethernet (1000Base-T)	Ethernet (10BASE-T/100BASE-TX, automatic switching)
Durability[2]	Outdoor display: up to 3 years unlaminated, 5 years laminated. Indoor display: up to 5 years unlaminated, 10 years laminated		Outdoor display: up to 3 years unlaminated.
RIP	SAI FlexiPrint HP Edition RIP included inbox HP Certified third-party RIP solutions		VersaWorks® RIP Software
Dimensions (w x d x h)	Printer: 2561 x 840 x 1380 mm (101 x 33 x 54 in), Shipping: 2795 x 760 x 1250 mm (110.1 x 30 x 49.3 in)		2575 x 795 x 1270 mm (101.4 x 31.3 x 50in)
Weight	Printer: 188 kg (414 lb), Shipping: 287 kg (633 lb)		140 kg (308.6 lb)
Warranty[3]	One-year limited hardware warranty		Two-Year Trouble-Free Warranty

Source data: Web and datasheets.

[1] Estimated street prices. Actual prices can vary depending on country.
[2] HP image permanence and scratch, smudge, and water resistance estimates by HP Image Permanence Lab. Outdoor display permanence tested according to SAE J2527 using HP Latex and eco-solvent ink on a range of media, including HP media; in a vertical display orientation in simulated nominal outdoor display conditions for select high and low climates, including exposure to direct sunlight and water; performance may vary as environmental conditions change.
[3] Warranty service availability and response time may vary from country/region to country/region. The only warranties for HP products and services are set forth in the express warranty statements accompanying such products and services.

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